

neighbors? Our grandchildren? Our neighbor's grandchildren and our grandchildren's neighbors? . . . By any standards," the review concludes, "we save too little." And, of course, for nearly all of us, saving—early, often, and regularly—is the key to wealth accumulation. It *is* as simple as that.

Another proven way to improve your savings accumulations is to postpone for as long as possible your first payments from Social Security. (The maximum yearly benefit for a married couple at age 62 is roughly \$28,800 in 2008; at age 70—when payments *must* begin—it would be \$47,700.) Still another way (you've heard this before!) is to invest rather than speculate. Always manage investment costs. Even that *Wall Street Journal* book review cited two tenets. "Moral: stick with low-fee funds. Bigger moral: there are some very simple things we can all do to become wiser investors."

When you plan your financial future, don't fool yourself by focusing on the nominal *gross* returns on stocks and bonds; subtract the costs you expect to be assessed, and work with net returns. Then assume that even those returns will be reduced by inflation. (You pick the number: 2.5 percent? 3.5? 4.5? More?) Set realistic goals that you can reasonably expect to achieve. I could give you dozens of additional tips on how to have enough, but I'd just be repeating what I've written in *Bogle on Mutual Funds* (1993), *Common Sense on Mutual Funds* (1999), and *The Little Book of Common Sense Investing* (2007).

Enough for America?

It seems probable—perhaps even likely—that most of you have enough to live at a reasonable, enjoyable standard of living, or are sufficiently financially savvy to reach the *enough* standard by the time your retirement comes, when the accumulation of wealth slows and the distribution of wealth begins. But, in conscience, I dare not fail to acknowledge the plight of literally millions of our fellow citizens who *don't* have enough, and who will *never* have enough to live at such a relatively lofty standard.